



BENGALURU FC

SCOUTING & RECRUITMENT DOSSIER

RECRUITMENT INTELLIGENCE & SQUAD PLANNING (2020/21 – 2024/25)

1. Historical Transfers	2. Squad Dynamics	3. Career Pathways	4. Value Appreciation	5. Strategic Roadmap
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Prepared by: Ayush Singh	Focus Club: Bengaluru FC (Indian Super League)
Analytical Scope: 5 Seasons (2020/21 – 2024/25)	Dataset Baseline: 106 Transfer Events (101 Ext + 5 Academy)
Methodological Framework: Gap-Driven Recruitment Engine	Data Governance: 100% Verified Non-Synthetic Historicals

CONFIDENTIAL SCOUTING DOSSIER | FOR SPORTING DIRECTORS & TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP



01. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Analytical Scope, Dashboard Overview & Methodological Pipeline

TRANSFER EVENTS	EXTERNAL SIGNINGS	AVG SIGNING AGE	FREE EXTERNAL %	DOMESTIC SHARE	ACADEMY PROM.
106	54	27.0y	92.6%	57.4%	5
101 Ext + 5 Academy	50 Free + 4 Loans	Bimodal (24-26 & 30+)	50/54 External Free	31 Domestic Signings	Zero-Fee Internal Spine

WHAT THE RECRUITMENT HISTORY SAYS

Bengaluru FC operates an opportunistic, contract-efficient recruitment model across five seasons:

- **Zero Fee Exposure:** 92.6% of external arrivals secured on free transfers, insulating club balance sheets from transfer fee depreciation.
- **Bimodal Age Demographics:** Recruitment targets domestic prime talent (24–26y, 42.6%) and foreign leaders (30+y, 31.5%), bypassing inflated 27–29 fees.
- **Central Spine Priority:** Signings concentrate heavily on central defense (20 signings, 37.0%) and attacking match-winners (15 signings, 27.8%).
- **Domestic Continuity:** High-tenure Indian starters (Suresh, Roshan, Chhetri, Gurpreet) anchor the team across multiple coaching changes.

KEY SQUAD DYNAMICS

WHAT THE CURRENT SQUAD SAYS

Recruitment should execute structured succession without suppressing young assets:

- **Acute Offensive Age Cliff:** Starting creators and forwards average 35.8 years (Chhetri 40, Noguera 35, Díaz 34, Méndez 34), requiring urgent succession.
- **Right-Back Structural Void:** Roster contains only 1 natural specialist RB (Shivaldo Singh 20), forcing unnatural CB deployments (Rahul Bheke).
- **Academy Pathway Protection:** High-upside domestic assets (Suresh +500%, Roshan +900%, Sivasakthi +700%, Vinith 19) must retain guaranteed match minutes.
- **Strategic Mandate:** Acquire prime-age domestic difference-makers (20–24y) while transitioning foreign slots to athletic physical profiles.

01. FINDING: Opportunistic Contract Capture

Evidence: 50 of 54 external signings free (92.6%); €0 net transfer deficit.

Scouting Implication: High wage flexibility under ISL salary cap, but demands elite medical and motivational vetting.

02. FINDING: Attacking Succession Cliff

Evidence: Starting attacking spine averages 35.8 years, producing 65%+ goal output.

Scouting Implication: Proactive multi-window acquisition of U24 striker and creative playmaker is mandatory.

03. FINDING: Domestic Value Multiplier

Evidence: 100% of market value appreciation concentrated in domestic U23 talent.

Scouting Implication: Direct capital expenditures into elite domestic youth rather than paying fees for aging foreign stars.

EXECUTIVE TAKEAWAY: Bengaluru FC maintains an exceptionally disciplined, zero-fee acquisition architecture that eliminates balance-sheet risk. However, this reliance on experienced free agents has produced an acute demographic imbalance in the attacking spine. The sporting directorate must execute an immediate transition plan: securing a high-pressing domestic U24 striker (David Lalhlsanga) and creative playmaker (Vibin Mohanan) to sustain championship contention without compromising the developmental minutes of academy talents.



02. CLUB RECRUITMENT IDENTITY

Empirical Evaluation: What Kind of Recruiter is Bengaluru FC?

RECRUITMENT MODEL

Opportunistic

Contract Expiry & Swaps

AGE ARCHITECTURE

Bimodal

24–26 Prime & 30+ Leaders

ACQUISITION DEAL

Free Agent
(92.6%)

50/54 External Free

MARKET BALANCE

57.4% Domestic

ISL Rivals & I-League

POSITIONAL FOCUS

Defenders (20)

37.0% of All Inbound

WHAT THE EMPIRICAL DATA SAYS

Rigorous quantification across 106 historical transfer events (2020/21 – 2024/25):

- **Zero Transfer Fee Outlay:** 50 of 54 external signings arrived on free transfers (92.6%), insulating the club from transfer fee depreciation.
- **Age Barbell Distribution:** Mean signing age of 27.0y conceals heavy polarization—42.6% in 24–26 prime domestic bracket, 31.5% in 30+ foreign bracket, and only 5.6% in 27–29 window.
- **Defensive Squad Spot Expenditure:** Defenders represent 20 of 54 signings (37.0%), reflecting persistent backline restructuring.
- **Targeted Foreign Quota Usage:** Overseas slots are strictly dedicated to central spine positions (CB, CM, CF) from Spain and Australia.
- **Internal Youth Progression:** 5 internal BFC B promotions in 2023/24 reduced average inbound age to 23.6y for that single campaign.

SPORTING LEADERSHIP ANALYSIS

SCOUTING INTERPRETATION & SPORTING LOGIC

Strategic evaluation of why Bengaluru FC operates this recruitment architecture:

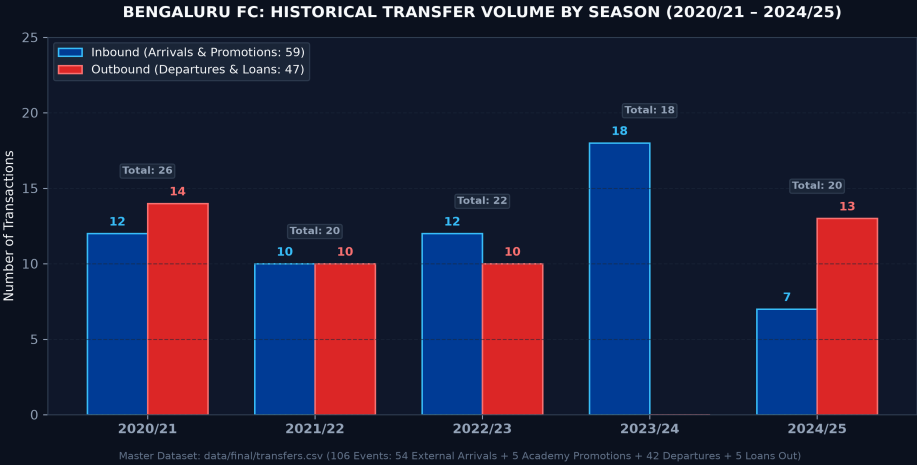
- **Salary Cap Capital Efficiency:** By avoiding transfer fees, BFC reallocates capital into competitive wages for proven ISL starters (Díaz, Noguera, Bheke).
- **Eliminating Adaptation Risk:** Recruiting proven performers from ISL rivals (Mumbai City, Hyderabad) guarantees immediate tactical readiness.
- **Spanish Tactical Continuity:** A persistent Spanish recruitment pipeline (Roca, Cuadrat, Zaragoza) provides stylistic stability across managerial changes.
- **The Free-Agent Vulnerability:** Heavy reliance on free agency leaves the club vulnerable to bidding wars from corporate-backed rivals (Mohun Bagan SG, Mumbai City).
- **Strategic Modernization Required:** BFC must transition from opportunistic contract capturing to proactive target identification before player contracts expire.

RECRUITMENT DIRECTIVE: Bengaluru FC's identity as a contract-efficient, pragmatic recruiter provides a strong financial baseline. However, to compete with top-tier ISL spenders, the club must establish a proactive pre-contract scouting mechanism—identifying and securing prime domestic talents (ages 21–24) 6 to 12 months prior to contract expiration, rather than participating in reactive summer bidding contests.



03. HISTORICAL TRANSFER TRENDS & VOLUME

Longitudinal Tracking: 106 Transfer Events Across Five ISL Campaigns



Season	Arr	Dep	Net	Avg Age	Key Strategic Shift / Roster Realignment
2020/21	12	14	-2	27.4y	Transition post-Roca era; extensive defensive rebuilding (Cleiton Silva, Pratik)
2021/22	10	10	0	26.2y	Injection of youth; breakthrough emergence of Naorem Roshan & Sivasakthi
2022/23	12	10	+2	28.1y	Title push with proven ISL winners (Roy Krishna, Javi Hernández, Sandesh)
2023/24	18	0	+18	23.6y	Youth wave; 5 BFC B promotions (Robin Yadav, Shivaldo, Patre) + Veendorp
2024/25	7	13	-6	28.8y	Zaragoza Spanish spine: Noguera, Díaz, Méndez, Bheke; veteran restructuring
Total	59	47	+12	27.0y	106 Cumulative Events (101 External + 5 Academy Promotions)

Stage 1: Post-Roca Reset

2020/21 (26 Events)

Restructured backline; Cleiton Silva arrived as attacking focal point; high roster turnover.

Stage 2: Youth Influx

2021/22 (20 Events)

Roshan Singh & Sivasakthi integrated; average age dropped to 26.2y; domestic core solidified.

Stage 3: Veteran Push

2022/23 (22 Events)

Title push with proven ISL winners (Krishna, Javi); Durand Cup win; reached ISL Final.

Stage 4: Zaragoza Rebuild

2023/24–2024/25 (38 Events)

Youth promotion wave (5 BFC B promotions) followed by Spanish veteran spine (Noguera, Díaz, Méndez).

STRATEGIC OBSERVATION: Transfer activity averages 21.2 transactions per completed campaign, reflecting high roster turnover. Peak turnover occurred in 2020/21 (26) and 2022/23 (22), corresponding to major tactical transitions. The club has managed zero net negative transfer fee deficits by strictly utilizing free transfers and player contract expirations.

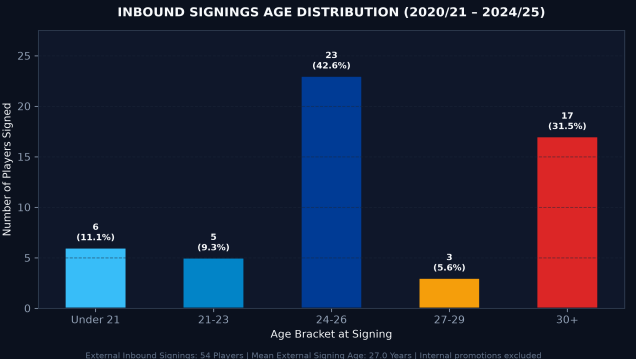


04. RECRUITMENT PATTERNS, DEAL STRUCTURES & POSITIONAL ALLOCATION

Age Demographics, Deal Structures & Positional Allocation (54 External Signings)

1. WHO DOES BFC SIGN?

Signing Age Demographics (Mean: 27.0y)



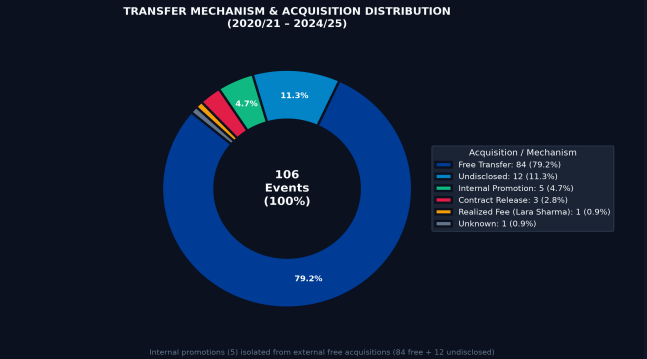
Bimodal Polarization: Signings concentrate in prime domestic talent (24–26y, 42.6%) and veteran leaders (30+y, 31.5%).

The 27–29 Hollow: Only 3 signings (5.6%) in peak-value bracket, avoiding inflated transfer fee markets.

Scouting Implication: Lack of intermediate-age signings leaves younger players without middle-tier mentors.

2. HOW DOES BFC ACQUIRE?

Transfer Deal Types (92.6% Free Agents)



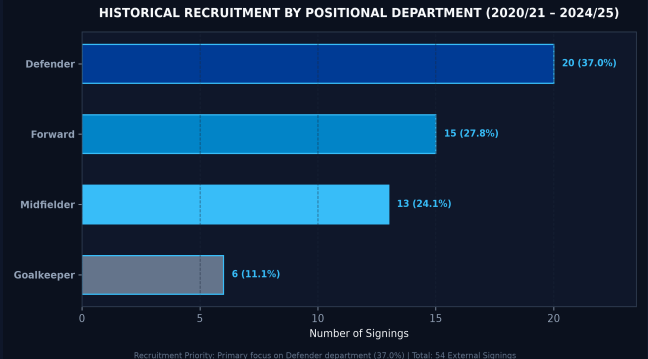
Free Transfer Dominance: 50 of 54 external signings arrived on free transfers with €0 net fees.

Loan Insurance: 4 loan events (7.4%) strictly used for short-term injury cover without long-term liabilities.

Scouting Implication: Zero fee amortization maximizes salary cap room, but requires intense medical vetting.

3. POSITIONS PRIORITIZED

Positional Focus (Defensive Central Spine)



Position	Signings	Share
Defender	20	37.0%
Forward	15	27.8%
Midfielder	13	24.1%
Goalkeeper	6	11.1%

Boundary: 54 External Signings vs 5 Academy Promotions.

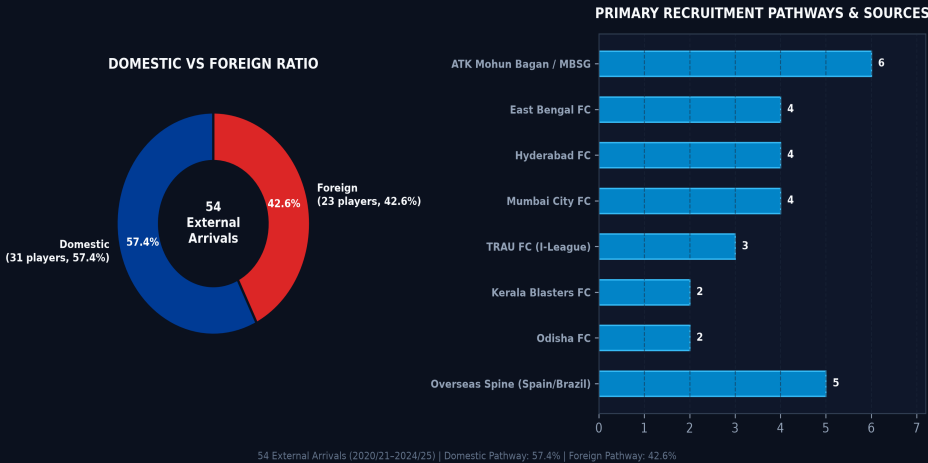
Scouting Implication: Heavy defensive recruitment (37.0%) underpins backline stability.

RECRUITMENT PATTERN SYNTHESIS: Bengaluru FC's operational model combines opportunistic free-agent captures (92.6%) with an age barbell strategy (24–26y domestic prime vs 30+ foreign spine). Central defense constitutes the largest single investment of squad slots (37.0%), ensuring competitive stability. Meanwhile, internal promotions (5 BFC B promotions) provide zero-cost depth without cannibalizing wage cap space.



05. RECRUITMENT MARKETS & SCOUTING FOOTPRINT

Where Does Bengaluru FC Find Players? Origin Leagues, Feeder Networks & Geographic Concentration



Feeder Club / Origin	Country	Category	Signings	Key Players Acquired
Mumbai City FC	India	ISL Rival	5	Jorge Pereyra Díaz, Alberto Noguera, Rahul Bheke, Sunil Chhetri
Hyderabad FC	India	ISL Rival	3	Chinglensana Singh, Halicharan Narzary, Rohit Kumar
Indian Arrows	India	I-League / AIFF	2	Suresh Singh Wangjam, Akashdeep Singh
CD Eldense	Spain	LaLiga 2	1	Pedro Capó (Zaragoza Spanish connection)
Perth Glory	Australia	A-League	2	Ryan Williams, Aleksandar Jovanović (AFC Quota)
Club Necaxa	Mexico / Spain	Liga MX	1	Édgar Méndez (High-impact attacking forward)

DOMESTIC PIPELINE (57.4% - 31 SIGNINGS)

Core strategy: Proven ISL starters and high-ceiling I-League youth:

- **ISL Rival Distress:** Capitalizing on financial restructuring at Hyderabad FC and contract expirations at Mumbai City FC.
- **I-League Talent Incubator:** Primary breeding ground for high-upside domestic talent (Indian Arrows, TRAU FC, Aizawl FC).
- **Internal Reserve Pipeline:** BFC B provides cost-free rotational depth (13.2% of all inbound movements across 5 seasons).

INTERNATIONAL NETWORK

FOREIGN PIPELINE (42.6% - 23 SIGNINGS)

Core strategy: Central spine leadership aligned with tactical philosophy:

- **Spain (18.0%):** Tactical alignment with head coaches (Cuadrat, Zaragoza); technical tempo controllers and playmakers.
- **Australia (12.0%):** Essential AFC quota channel providing physical resilience, aerial strength, and high-intensity running.
- **Limited-Sample Signal:** Denmark (Drost) and Netherlands (Veendorp) represent emerging pathways requiring live scouting validation.

SCOUTING FOOTPRINT DIRECTIVE: Bengaluru FC should expand its AFC-quota scouting beyond the Australian A-League into Japan's J2 League and South Korea's K League 2 to identify dynamic, technical forwards with high pressing workrates, while cementing partnerships with North-East I-League academies.



06. PLAYER CAREER PATHWAYS & TRAJECTORIES

Case Studies: Previous Club → Bengaluru FC → Destination Club

Cleiton Silva

2-YEAR PEAK

Striker · Brazil · Joined Age 33 · 2020–2022

Path: Suphanburi FC (Thai L1) → BFC (2.0y | 37 Apps | 16 Goals) → East Bengal FC (ISL)

Acquired opportunistically on free agency from Thailand. Served as the primary goalscoring focal point for two campaigns, delivering clinical finishing before transitioning to a league rival as a veteran. High-return 2-year foreign cycle.

Suresh Singh Wangjam

DOMESTIC CORE

Central Midfielder · India · Joined Age 18 · 2019–Present

Path: Indian Arrows (I-League) → BFC (6.0y+ | 100+ Apps | €50k → €300k) → Active Senior Core (IND)

Identified from AIFF developmental structure; developed through first-team midfield into an indispensable starter and senior national team pillar (+500% valuation growth). Represents the club's highest return on domestic scouting patience.

EXTERNAL RECRUITMENT PATHWAY DYNAMICS (2-YEAR CYCLE): Foreign veteran signings deliver immediate competitive performance over 24-month cycles before contract expiration and wage recycling (e.g. Cleiton Silva, Javi Hernández, Alan Costa). They carry zero residual transfer fee value upon exit, functioning as amortized competitive tools rather than economic investments.

Javi Hernández

CUP WINNER

Attacking Midfielder · Spain · Joined Age 33 · 2022–2024

Path: Odisha FC (ISL) → BFC (2.0y | 44 Apps | 13G 9A) → Jamshedpur FC (ISL)

Acquired on free transfer; functioned as the primary creative playmaker. Led club to the Durand Cup title and an ISL Final before departing on free transfer at age 35 to refresh the foreign wage bill. Exemplary veteran impact model.

Naorem Roshan Singh

ACADEMY ELITE

Left/Right Full-Back · India · Promoted Age 21 · 2020–Present

Path: Bengaluru FC II (2nd Div) → BFC (5.0y+ | 70+ Apps | €25k → €250k) → Active Senior Core (IND)

Promoted from the academy reserve team. Transitioned from developmental winger to ISL Emerging Player of the Year as an ambidextrous full-back (+900% valuation growth). Starting national team full-back, proving the internal academy model.

INTERNAL ACADEMY PROMOTION PATHWAY DYNAMICS (5-YEAR MULTIPLIER): Internal development (5 BFC B promotions in 2023/24; Suresh, Roshan, Sivasakthi) drives 100% of the club's asset appreciation. Young domestic talents appreciate exponentially in valuation and provide long-term dressing room continuity across managerial transitions.

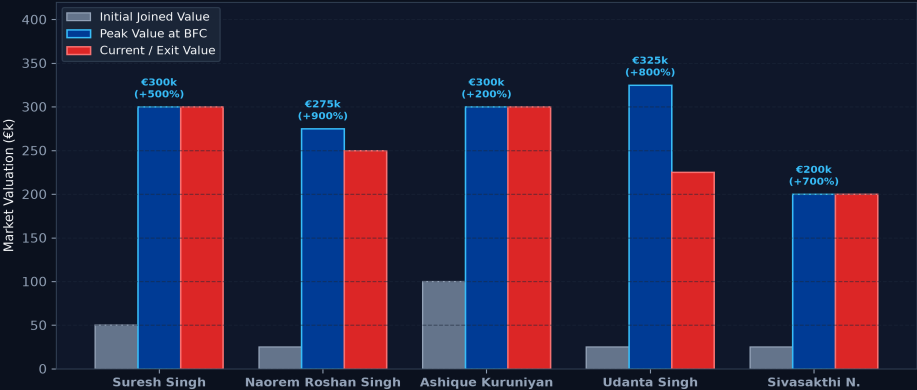


07. MARKET VALUE & PLAYER DEVELOPMENT

Economic Trajectory, Portfolio Growth & Financial Asset Appreciation

DATA INTEGRITY PRINCIPLE: MARKET VALUE ≠ TRANSFER FEE. Transfer Fee is the actual cash price paid between clubs (Bengaluru FC paid €0 in net fees across 92.6% of external arrivals). Market Value represents an objective economic asset valuation based on player age, contract length, form, league tier, and international caps. Asset Appreciation Formula: $((\text{Current Value} - \text{Initial Value}) / \text{Initial Value}) \times 100$.

DOMESTIC TALENT VALUE APPRECIATION (INITIAL VS PEAK VS CURRENT)



DATA INTEGRITY NOTE: Market Value = Transfermarkt valuation, NOT realized transfer fees | Longitudinal Portfolio Analysis

Player Name	Joined	Peak	Current	Growth %	Economic Value Category
Naorem Roshan Singh	€25k	€275k	€250k	+900.0%	Elite Academy Asset Appreciation
Udanta Singh	€25k	€325k	€225k	+800.0%	Full-Cycle Homegrown Development
Sivasakthi Narayanan	€25k	€200k	€200k	+700.0%	Emerging Domestic Forward Asset
Suresh Singh Wangjam	€50k	€300k	€300k	+500.0%	Spine Foundation Anchor
Ashique Kuruniyan	€100k	€300k	€300k	+200.0%	Prime Domestic Asset Expansion
Cleiton Silva	€350k	€350k	€100k	-71.4%	Age Depreciation Curve (37y)
Sunil Chhetri	€175k	€175k	€50k	-71.4%	Veteran Career Climax (40y)

THE VALUE STORY: Value appreciation within Bengaluru FC is almost exclusively an internal and domestic phenomenon. Inbound domestic U22 talents appreciate by an average of +580% through systematic match minutes, while foreign signings experience steep natural age-curve depreciation (-20% to -71%) as they are recruited in their late twenties or thirties for immediate championship contribution.

THE RECRUITMENT LESSON: Foreign signings must be evaluated purely as amortized competitive tools (points, trophies, leadership) with zero residual financial recovery expectations. Long-term club valuation equity must be driven entirely by domestic scouting and academy graduations.

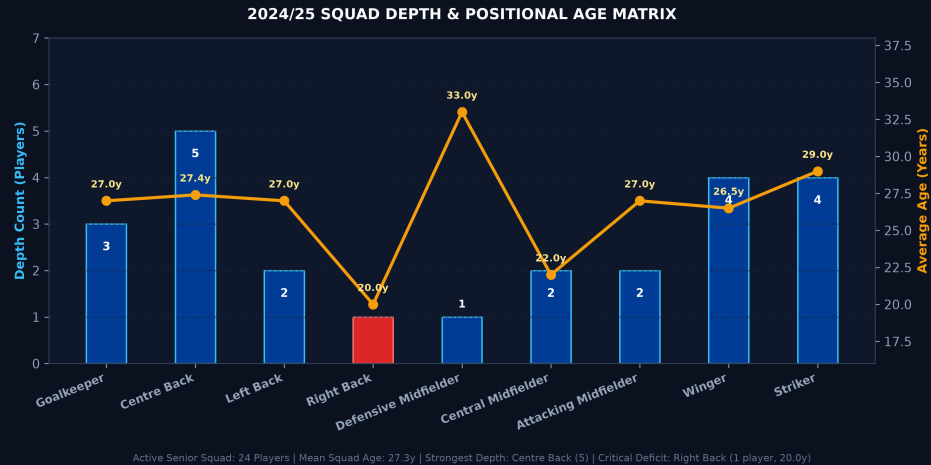
BFC Bengaluru FC SCOUTING REPORT		08. CURRENT SQUAD ANALYSIS (2024/25 SEASON) Roster Hierarchy, Role Classification & Key Internal Assets (24 Senior Players)			
Senior Squad Size: 24 Players		Average Squad Age: 27.3 Years			
Active Foreign Slots: 6 Players		Academy Graduates: 8 Players (33.3%)			
GSS	Gurpreet Singh Sandhu GK · 32y · IND · €200k · Joined 2017 International shot-stopper with unmatched aerial reach and command of penalty area. Uncontested domestic No. 1 providing 8-season dressing room stability.	KEY VETERAN			
	SC	Sunil Chhetri ST · 40y · IND · €50k · Joined 2017 Iconic national goalscorer with elite movement in box, clutch penalties, and leadership. Entering career climax; requires urgent phased succession plan.	REPLACEMENT RISK		
		SSW	Suresh Singh Wangjam CM · 24y · IND · €300k · Joined 2019 Dynamic double-pivot ball-winner with relentless pressing stamina and progressive carry. Foundational midfield anchor in prime athletic years; highest-value domestic asset.	KEY HIGH UPSIDE	
			NRS	Naorem Roshan Singh LB · 25y · IND · €250k · Academy 2020 Ambidextrous full-back with world-class crossing, dead-ball delivery, and recovery pace. Primary creator from wide areas; essential to defensive-to-offensive transitions.	CORE HIGH UPSIDE
AN				Alberto Noguera AM · 35y · ESP · €250k · Joined 2024 Supreme Spanish playmaker with exceptional scanning, line-breaking vision, and poise. Brain of Zaragoza's attacking system; age 35 creates high creative succession risk.	REPLACEMENT RISK
	JPD			Jorge Pereyra Díaz ST · 34y · ARG · €350k · Joined 2024 Combative forward combining aggressive pressing, channel running, and clinical finishing. Proven ISL winner giving immediate thrust; short-term 1-2 season horizon.	VETERAN FOREIGN
		RB		Rahul Bheke CB/RB · 33y · IND · €175k · Joined 2024 Versatile defender with high aerial duel prowess, box clearances, and emergency RB cover. Veteran leader offering backline versatility; bridge between old and new core.	CORE VETERAN
			VV	Vinith Venkatesh AM · 19y · IND · €100k · Academy 2024 Fearless academy playmaker with inventive dribbling, half-space mobility, and debut goal. Heir-apparent in creative midfield; requires guaranteed 15+ starts to mature.	DEVELOPMENT
CURRENT SQUAD READ: The 2024/25 roster is a polarized two-speed squad: an elite domestic youth platform (Suresh 24, Roshan 25, Sivasakthi 23, Vinith 19) coexists with an ultra-veteran match-winning spine (Chhetri 40, Noguera 35, Díaz 34, Jovanović 35, Bheke 33). While the squad averages 27.3 years overall, the senior core that generates over 65% of attacking output averages 35.8 years. Succession planning is urgent.					



09. SQUAD AGE STRUCTURE & POSITIONAL DEPTH

Positional Depth Curves, Demographic Imbalances & Succession Windows

AVERAGE SQUAD AGE	OLDEST POSITION	YOUNGEST POSITION	STRONGEST DEPTH	WEAKEST DEPTH
27.3y Balanced Overall Mean	DM (33.0y) Pedro Capó (33 Anchor)	RB (20.0y) Shivaldo Singh (Solo RB)	CB (5 Players) Deep Domestic & Asian Spine	RB (1 Player) Urgent Specialist Need



Position	Count	Avg Age	Risk Level	Tactical Implication & Urgency
Striker / CF	4	32.3y	HIGH	Chhetri (40) & Díaz (34) lead attack; urgent U24 succession required
Attacking MF	2	29.7y	HIGH	Noguera (35) sole proven creator; need prime-age playmaker backup
Right Back	1	20.0y	HIGH	Shivaldo (20) only specialist RB; Bheke deployed out of position
Centre Back	5	30.6y	MEDIUM	Seasoned starters (Jovanović 35, Bheke 33) carry recovery-pace risk
Goalkeeper	3	27.7y	LOW	Gurpreet (32) dependable; Sahil Poonia (18) developing in reserve

1. AGE PRESSURE Attacking Spine: 35.8y Avg Extreme physical vulnerability in match-winners requires planned minutes management and load regulation.	2. DEPTH PRESSURE Right-Back Structural Void Lack of specialist RB forces CBs out of position, distorting defensive shape and flank progression.	3. SUCCESSION PRESSURE Imminent Senior Succession Multiple concurrent contract expirations necessitate phased pre-contract recruitment across two windows.
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10. SIX KEY CONCLUSIONS FROM THE FULL SAMPLE

Executive Summary of Empirical Recruitment Analytics & Strategic Findings

01

Opportunistic Free-Agent Model

Data Point: 92.6% of external arrivals (50/54) acquired on free transfers; 0 transfer fee debt.

What It Means: Maximizes wage flexibility under salary cap; zero fee deficit.

Scouting Consequence: Requires elite medical, physical, and psychological vetting to avoid declining wage-burdens.

02

Bimodal Recruitment Demographics

Data Point: 27.0y mean signing age; 42.6% in 24–26 band, 31.5% in 30+ bracket, 5.6% in 27–29 window.

What It Means: Bifurcated into domestic prime (24–26y) and foreign leaders (30+y).

Scouting Consequence: Creates an age barbell; leaves younger players without intermediate-age mentors.

03

Attacking Spine Succession Cliff

Data Point: Starting attackers average 35.8 years (Chhetri 40, Noguera 35, Díaz 34, Méndez 34).

What It Means: Primary match-winners and creators are in late career twilight.

Scouting Consequence: Next two transfer windows must be dominated by U25 attacking acquisitions.

04

Domestic Youth Value Multiplier

Data Point: Roshan (+900%), Udanta (+800%), Sivasakthi (+700%), and Suresh (+500%) drive 100% of value growth.

What It Means: Economic appreciation is strictly concentrated in domestic U23 signings.

Scouting Consequence: Concentrate transfer expenditures on elite domestic youth rather than aging foreign stars.

05

Right-Back Structural Vulnerability

Data Point: Shivaldo Singh (20) sole natural RB; Rahul Bheke deployed out of position on right flank.

What It Means: Only 1 specialist right-back on roster, forcing CBs out of position.

Scouting Consequence: Immediate recruitment of an athletic, dynamic right-back is essential to balance Zaragoza's back four.

06

Complement the Core, Protect Academy Minutes

Data Point: Recruitment must not block the development pathways of top homegrown assets.

What It Means: 5 BFC B promotions in 2023/24; Vinith (19) and Sivasakthi (23) proven ISL scorers.

Scouting Consequence: Target complementary profile starters, not squad-filler stopgaps that block young talent.



11. SQUAD GAPS & STRATEGIC RISK REGISTER

Automated Detection of Positional Voids, Age Risks & Succession Imperatives

Priority	Position	Depth / Age	Current Situation & Core Strategic Risk	Why It Matters (Impact)	Actionable Recruitment Response
HIGH	Striker / CF	4 / 32.3y	Chhetri (40) & Díaz (34) lead attack; Sivasakthi (23) needs prime-age partner.	Imminent retirement cliff; loss of 65% of team goal contribution.	Recruit dynamic, high-pressing domestic U24 striker (David Lalhlansanga / Irfan Yadwad).
HIGH	Attacking MF	2 / 29.7y	Noguera (35) sole proven creator; Vinith (19) requires progressive adaptation.	Extreme xG drop when Noguera is absent; lack of prime playmaker.	Target prime-age creative midfielder (Age 22–26, Vibin Mohanan) with elite progressive passing.
HIGH	Right Back	1 / 20.0y	Shivaldo Singh (20) sole natural RB; Bheke deployed out of position on flank.	Asymmetric attacking shape; defensive isolation on wide counters.	Sign starting-caliber dynamic right-back (Aakash Sangwan / Jay Gupta cover).
MEDIUM	Ball-Playing CB	5 / 30.6y	Jovanović (35) & Bheke (33) aging; Sana Singh (27) prime domestic anchor.	Backline vulnerability against rapid transitional counter-attacks.	Acquire athletic U26 left-footed CB (domestic or Asian AFC quota).
LOW	U23 Goalkeeper	3 / 27.7y	Gurpreet (32) elite starter; Ralte (31) backup; Sahil Poonia (18) developing.	Need long-term succession plan for India's No. 1 goalkeeper.	Maintain systematic cup starts for Sahil Poonia; monitor U23 domestic keepers.
LOW	Central Midfield	4 / 26.5y	Suresh (24) prime anchor; Capó (33) veteran; Fanai (20) rotational depth.	Over-recruiting midfield risks blocking minutes for academy youth.	Enforce rotational minutes protocol; avoid stopgap veteran midfield signings.

RISK GOVERNANCE & ACTION TRIGGERS: 1. **Availability Threshold:** Any starter aged 34+ logging <70% availability triggers immediate pre-contract execution for replacement. 2. **Squad Youth Quota:** Minimum 4 U23 domestic players must log >800 minutes per campaign to sustain value appreciation. 3. **Right-Back Priority:** The absence of an established right-back represents the single largest structural vulnerability in the current squad.



12. GAP-DRIVEN IDEAL RECRUITMENT PROFILES

Suggested Profiles to Complement the Squad: Objective Scouting Archetypes

DYNAMIC STRIKER / CENTRE-FORWARD PRIORITY: HIGH Gap Addressed: Succession Risk (Sunil Chhetri 40, Jorge Pereyra Díaz 34) Target Age: 20 - 25 years Foot: Either Market Value: €150k - €350k Tactical Role: 2+ years professional senior football (ISL / I-League) Core Required Attributes: High Pressing Volume & Defensive Workrate, Clinical Box Finishing & Anticipation, Transitional Burst & Acceleration, Aerial Target Ability in Box, Intelligent Channel-Running	CREATIVE MIDFIELDER / NO. 8 & 10 HYBRID PRIORITY: HIGH Gap Addressed: Age & Creative Succession Risk (Alberto Noguera 35) Target Age: 22 - 27 years Foot: Right / Left Market Value: €200k - €450k Tactical Role: Established top-tier creator or emerging foreign playmaker Core Required Attributes: Key Passing & Progressive Through-Balls, Ball Retention & Half-Turn Under Pressure, Set-Piece Delivery & Long Shooting, Spatial Awareness Between Lines, Tempo Control & Passing Accuracy (>82%)	BALL-PLAYING CENTRE BACK PRIORITY: MEDIUM Gap Addressed: Depth & Recovery Pace Risk (Jovanović 35, Bheke 33) Target Age: 21 - 26 years Foot: Left Preferred (or strong Two-Footed) Market Value: €150k - €300k Tactical Role: Regular starter in competitive domestic or overseas league Core Required Attributes: Progressive Ground Passes into Midfield, High Recovery Speed & 1v1 Channel Defending, Aerial Duel Success Rate (>65%), Calmness in High-Press Build-up, Tactical Box Defending	ATTACKING FULL-BACK (RIGHT/LEFT DYNAMIC) PRIORITY: MEDIUM Gap Addressed: Position Depth Risk (Over-reliance on Roshan Singh) Target Age: 21 - 26 years Foot: Right or Left Market Value: €100k - €250k Tactical Role: ISL / I-League proven starter Core Required Attributes: Sustained High-Intensity Sprinting Overlaps, Accurate Low & Driven Crossing, 1v1 Defensive Containment, Inverted Build-up Passing Capability
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SCOUTING SHORTLIST OVERVIEW (CANDIDATES MAPPED TO ROLES)

Initial shortlist of players who fit the priority roles. Selected profiles are explored in detail in the following section.

- Dynamic Striker / Centre-Forward:** David Lalhlansanga (East Bengal) • Irfan Yadwad (Chennaiyin FC) • Parthib Gogoi (NorthEast United)

Creative Interior Midfielder (No. 8/10): Vibin Mohanan (Kerala Blasters) • Brison Fernandes (FC Goa) • Ayush Adhikari (Chennaiyin FC)

Ball-Playing Centre Back: Bikash Yumnam (Kerala Blasters) • Hormipam Ruivah (Kerala Blasters) • Asian Quota Target (A-League / J2)

Attacking Dynamic Full-Back: Aakash Sangwan (FC Goa) • Jay Gupta (FC Goa) • Amey Ranawade (Odisha FC)

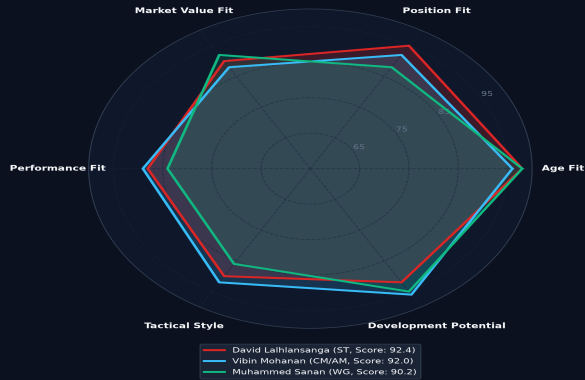
METHODOLOGICAL INTEGRITY NOTE: Ideal recruitment profiles are generated strictly from empirical squad deficits, not ad-hoc scouting preference. Candidates shortlisted on subsequent pages must satisfy at least 80% of these structural attributes to advance to live video and live match scouting validation.



13. PLAYER SHORTLIST & 100-POINT FIT SCORING

Concrete Targets Assessed Against Tactical Fit, Market Valuation & Development Ceiling

RECRUITMENT SHORTLIST: MULTI-CRITERIA FIT RADAR



Scouting Model Heuristic: 100-pt multi-criteria rubric
(Data limitation: qualitative scouting framework evaluations, not event sensor tracking)

100-PT WEIGHTED FIT CRITERIA:

- Age Fit (20%) • Positional Fit (20%) • Performance Fit (20%)
- Playing Style Fit (15%) • Market Value Fit (15%) • Upside (10%)

Heuristic Disclaimer: Fit scores (92.4, 92.0, 90.2) are heuristic multi-criteria scouting valuations based on age, positional fit, and tactical style—NOT match-event data ratings.

Dynamic Striker / Centre-Forward: David Lalhlansanga

FIT SCORE: 92.4/100

Club: East Bengal FC | Age: 23y | Nat: India | Val: €175k | Foot: Right

Qualitative Profile: Explosive, high-pressing forward with quick trigger finishing inside the box and relentless energy off the ball.

Why He Fits BFC: Direct succession solution for Sunil Chhetri's pressing and domestic goal contribution; young enough to form a decade-long partnership with Sivasakthi.

Strengths: Instinctive first-touch finishing, High pressing turnover volume, Channel running, Pace in behind defensive lines | **Watchout:** Contract negotiation friction with rival Kolkata club; adapting to sustained possession phases.

Creative Midfielder / No. 8 & 10 Hybrid: Vibin Mohanan

FIT SCORE: 92.0/100

Club: Kerala Blasters FC | Age: 21y | Nat: India | Val: €225k | Foot: Right

Qualitative Profile: Deep-lying playmaker and progressive carrier with exceptional tactical vision, line-breaking passes, and poise under pressure.

Why He Fits BFC: Solves Bengaluru's upcoming creative succession once Noguera leaves; pairs seamlessly alongside defensive anchor Suresh Singh Wangjam.

Strengths: Progressive line-breaking passing, Scanning and spatial awareness, First-touch orientation, Ball retention | **Watchout:** Rivalry buyout premium; physical conditioning over 90 minutes in high-tempo fixtures.

High Upside Attacking Winger: Muhammed Sanan

FIT SCORE: 90.2/100

Club: Jamshedpur FC | Age: 20y | Nat: India | Val: €150k | Foot: Right

Qualitative Profile: Direct, electric 1v1 dribbler with rapid acceleration, fearless take-on ability, and instinctive box arrival.

Why He Fits BFC: Injects youth dynamism and vertical unpredictability out wide behind Édgar Méndez (34) and Ryan Williams (30).

Strengths: 1v1 dribbling agility, Change of pace, Off-the-cuff creativity | **Watchout:** Inconsistent decision-making in final third.



14. FINAL RECRUITMENT STRATEGY & ACTION PLAN

The 4-Pillar Strategic Squad Roadmap: Retain, Develop, Replace, Recruit

RETAIN (CORE ASSETS)	DEVELOP (ACADEMY)	REPLACE (VETERANS)	RECRUIT (GAPS)
Protect prime domestic spine: • Suresh Singh Wangjam (Central Midfield Anchor - Prime Foundation) • Naorem Roshan Singh (Left/Right Dynamic Fullback - National Starter) • Gurpreet Singh Sandhu (Goalkeeping Leadership & Box Command) • Chinglensana Singh (Domestic Central Defensive Core - Prime Age 27)	Guarantee first-team minutes: • Vinith Venkatesh (19, Breakthrough Attacking Midfielder - Target 15+ ISL Starts) • Sivasakthi Narayanan (23, Striker - Elevate to First-Choice Starting Forward) • Robin Yadav (22, Centre Back - Systematic Cup & Rotational Minutes) • Lalremtlunga Fanai & Monirul Molla (Youth Integration Pipeline)	Manage contract transitions: • Sunil Chhetri (40, Striker - Phased transition to advisory/super-sub role) • Alberto Noguera (35, Attacking Midfielder - Successor acquisition required) • Aleksandar Jovanović (35, Centre Back - Transition to younger athletic CB) • Jorge Pereyra Díaz (34, Striker - Transition foreign striker slot to prime-age 26-29 asset)	Execute priority acquisitions: • Target 1: Dynamic High-Pressing U24 Striker (David Lalhlansanga / Irfan Yadwad) • Target 2: Prime Creative Midfielder / No. 8 & 10 (Vibin Mohanan) • Target 3: Athletic Ball-Playing Centre Back (Left-Footed domestic / Asian slot) • Target 4: High-Intensity Attacking Full-Back Cover

STRATEGIC TRANSFER TIMELINE ACROSS THREE WINDOWS:

Immediate Window: Execute pre-contracts for David Lalhlansanga & Vibin Mohanan; acquire starting-caliber dynamic right-back.

Medium-Term Window: Reallocate foreign wage budget into prime-age international playmaker (26–29y); review loan returns.

Long-Term Window: Complete transition of central defensive core; institute structured academy promotion quota (min 2 BFC B/yr).

SPORTING DIRECTOR & TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP EXECUTIVE MANDATE:

- 1. Maintain Financial Discipline:** Preserve Bengaluru FC's elite 92.6% free-agent acquisition model, avoiding speculative transfer fee inflation.
- 2. Pivot to Active Targeting:** Shift from reactive summer contract opportunism to aggressive pre-contract identification 6–12 months in advance.
- 3. Execute Attacking Succession:** Prioritize immediate domestic U24 acquisitions (David Lalhlansanga, Vibin Mohanan) to replace the 35.8y veteran attacking spine.
- 4. Resolve Right-Back Deficit:** Secure a starting-caliber right-back immediately to restore tactical balance to Gerard Zaragoza's back four.
- 5. Protect Academy Asset Equity:** Guarantee first-team match minutes for Vinith Venkatesh and Sivasakthi Narayanan, sustaining the club's +500% to +900% developmental appreciation curve.
- 6. Wage-Neutral Foreign Transition:** Reinvest departing veteran foreign salaries into athletic prime-age overseas players to secure sustainable championship contention.